# Nikos Vasileiadis

**Software Engineering Manager** · Leeds, UK (GMT/BST - 1 hour behind CET) · British & Greek (EU) Citizen
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## Summary

Engineering Manager with 20+ years in technology and 9 years in leadership - 4 of them line-managing engineers - working across regulated industries - financial services, utilities, energy, and public sector technology. I combine technical depth, people development, and organisational judgment. Architecture discussions, daily PR reviews, planning, and stakeholder work are part of my regular practice. I give engineers ownership of solutions and contribute directly to implementation where it helps the team deliver. Introduced structured delivery in three resistant environments (financial services, a global brand agency, and a greenfield platform team). Currently managing platform and content services at Utility Warehouse (FTSE 250), a UK multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile and insurance.

Based in Leeds, UK. Greek (EU) citizen - full right to work in the Netherlands and across the EU. Open to remote roles with Dutch and European organisations. The timezone overlap with CET is seamless.

## What I Bring

- **People & teams** - Building and retaining remote engineering teams with cultural intelligence; measurement-led via DORA metrics, team health tracking, and Heartbeat surveys; reorg communication on a cadence - including empty updates when there's nothing new.
- **Organisational design** - Navigating restructurings, building teams from scratch, aligning team structures with what the business actually needs. Have built the same team twice from zero; staff complementary pairs, not just headcount.
- **Technical direction** - Architecture review, daily PR reviews, and direct implementation alongside people management; React, TypeScript, GraphQL, Contentful, and Kubernetes.
- **Platform & infrastructure** - Running critical platform services with clear SLAs and operational discipline for 15+ dependent engineering teams.
- **Design systems** - From co-creating an open-source design system (Pulsar) to leading enterprise-wide adoption across 20 teams.
- **Commercial awareness** - a six-figure vendor portfolio across six platform services, CapEx/OpEx planning, and vendor evaluation; commercial literacy from sitting with compliance, marketing, data, and IT.

## Experience

### Software Engineering Manager

**Utility Warehouse** (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 - multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)
Jul 2023 - Present · United Kingdom · Remote

- **Team & retention:** Grew to 8 technical reports across three teams with separate backlogs - web/CMS/tracking, mobile, and design systems - alongside a Product Manager. Everyone who wanted to stay, stayed - 100% retention through three reorganisations across three departments in 25 months; all reductions were organisational, zero voluntary attrition. Involved in hiring 2 external engineers and 4 internal transfers.
- **Growing people, measurably:** Supported 3 promotions (Associate → Mid, Mid → Senior) with evidence-based cases informed by DORA metrics and monthly Peakon Heartbeat surveys - acting on the signals, not just collecting them. Developed engineers who hadn't found the right home elsewhere in the organisation. Engineers I mentored are now Engineering Managers, both inside and outside the company.
- **Navigating restructurings:** Took responsibility for scoping team migrations - mapping scope, aligning stakeholders, and building consensus for where the team should sit. Negotiated skill inbound - a Senior Engineer with mobile expertise - when a mobile backlog was added, rather than stretching the existing team thin; argued successfully for keeping the Design Systems team separate when a restructuring proposal would have merged it into another team - the team that later enabled the company-wide rebrand.
- **Documentation & upskilling:** Wrote over 100 articles of technical documentation for a team that inherited an undocumented legacy CMS. When the team needed Kubernetes knowledge, I learned it first, then trained the team and documented it. Engineers own RFCs and present at cross-team forums.
- **Platform modernisation & rebrand (Oct 2025 - Apr 2026):** Led the CMSv2-to-CMSv3 transition and brand refresh across 522 pages. Reviewed architecture proposed by engineers, challenged scope, and implemented selected

redesigned components. Raised risks early, secured temporary support through my manager, and helped defer tracking and experimentation work to protect the fixed launch date.
- **Migration & editor experience:** Worked with engineers on scripted content migration, preview access, and a coordinated launch with a documented reversal procedure. Reduced the component set and acted on editor feedback; following launch, we observed fewer support requests.
- **Platform reliability:** uw.co.uk operated against a 99.99% SLO - a single incident in the current year, resolved within hours - with <3s page load on critical pages. The estate: 522 pages, 3,157 media assets, 1,090 shortlinks, 218 redirects. Supporting 8 content teams (33 users) and 15+ engineering teams across six platform services: Contentful CMS, Google Tag Manager, Snowplow, Mixpanel, Optimizely, OneTrust.
- **Design Systems (Hearth):** The Hearth Design System reached 20 engineering and product teams (15 full adoption, 5 partial), removing thousands of hours of duplicated work across the organisation.
- **CMS migration (Apostrophe → Contentful):** Replaced a legacy CMS that had no SLA, no SSO, and an ageing tech stack. A 2-month evaluation across 10 vendors led to Contentful on an enterprise contract, chosen for enterprise-grade SLAs and support. Zero-disruption migration; three marketing teams (~18 people) gained structured content models and scheduling. The in-house delivery platform (Next.js / React / TypeScript) runs its own GraphQL API over Contentful's content APIs - request bundling, query optimisation, and on-demand content revalidation, a layer above what the vendor provides.
- **Working with constraints (2025-present):** With the team at a specialist core of 2 engineers after the reorganisations, I took on Product Manager and on-call responsibilities alongside my management role. The team continued to deliver across 6 platform services without breaching the platform SLO, with full accountability for the uw.co.uk estate.

### Lead Software Engineer

**Utility Warehouse** (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 - multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)
May 2022 - Jul 2023 · United Kingdom · Remote

Joined as the founding engineer in a standalone team supporting marketing - no department, no precedent, no documentation.

- Started as three - myself, a Product Manager, and an Associate Engineer - and held that shape for a full year. Line-managed the engineer from May 2022: for my first year I reported directly to a VP of Engineering - no Head of Engineering in between - so people responsibility was mine from the start, 14 months before the title followed. Grew to five in May 2023 with two external hires; promoted the founding Associate to Software Engineer a month later - a promotion case I was asked to prepare and drive while still Lead. Renamed Content Capability (Nov 2022) and moved into the Platforms department (May 2023) - the first of three reorganisations the team would outlast.
- Set up a Scrum environment with structured backlog and predictable delivery, filling Product Manager gaps when needed. Conducted systematic discovery on the legacy CMS, authored the team's foundational documentation.
- Led the vendor evaluation that resulted in UW adopting Contentful as its enterprise CMS. Presented findings and full audit trail to leadership.

### Senior Full Stack Developer & Scrum Master

**IMA-HOME**
Jan 2020 - Apr 2022 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Combined frontend architecture with Scrum Master responsibilities for global clients (Adidas, MARS).

- Introduced structured Agile/Scrum practices to an agency that had been running on ad-hoc delivery. Result: measurable sprint velocity, predictable project allocation, and regular client demos.
- Architected the frontend for Royal Canin's global web presence - a single design system serving 30+ countries including Japan and Saudi Arabia, with RTL and vertical reading direction support.

### Senior Digital Developer & Scrum Master

**Leeds Building Society** (5th largest UK building society · £31B+ assets)
Oct 2018 - Jan 2020 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Maintained public-facing digital assets for the UK's 5th largest building society - a regulated financial services environment - while mentoring teams on code quality and UX standards.

- Introduced Agile and Scrum to LBS for the first time - voluntary ways-of-working forums that grew championing into a parallel Scrum Master role, then a formal Interim SM appointment (Jun-Oct 2019) to stabilise Digital Transformation alongside external consultants.

### UX Interface Developer & Scrum Master

**Jadu**
Jan 2017 - Oct 2018 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Designed UIs and developed features for an award-winning CMS used by UK Local Authorities, universities, and third-sector organisations. Strict focus on accessibility and W3C standards.

- Co-created **Pulsar** - an open-source UX and Interface Design System powering the Jadu Continuum Platform. This is where my design systems specialism started.
- Owned the full feature lifecycle for the CMS product - contextual inquiry at client sites (councils, universities), field research reports, mockups, usability testing, and production release.
- Gained hands-on Agile leadership through a rotating Scrum Master model.

### Early Career, Teaching & Community

Oct 2005 - Dec 2016 (11 years)

Provincial northern Greece - Xanthi, where I grew up; Serres, where I studied: no tech industry and, after 2010, barely an economy. I built the career anyway, and led long before I had a title for it.

- **Web development & freelancing (2005-2015):** Delivered 40+ web projects across Greece and internationally - from local non-profits to a Bitcoin job board for a client in California. Managed client relationships, billing (40/40/20 payment terms), and coordinated with distributed teams.
- **Teaching & mentorship (2006-2012):** Earned a Certified Training Professional qualification. Taught ECDL to adult learners for a year. Privately tutored a student in programming and hardware - that student went on to earn a BSc and MSc in Manchester and is now an Engineering Manager.
- **Community & civic technology (2008-2014):** Co-founded the Serres Linux Users Group, organised FOSSCOMM 2012 (a 350-person national open-source conference), and managed digital presence for UNESCO Serres, the local Natural History Museum, and community organisations. This work directly shaped my later community involvement in the UK.
- **UK agency work (2015-2016):** Relocated to Leeds. Built responsive e-commerce for global brands (Vivienne Westwood) and focused on frontend performance.

## Community & Volunteering

**Mentor, WRK digital** *(Feb 2023-Present)*: Part of a peer mentoring network spanning EMs, Heads of Engineering, VPs, and CTOs.

**Mentor, School of Code** *(Aug 2023-Jan 2024)*: Supported people entering the industry through their first engineering roles.

**Lead Organiser, Google Developers Group Leeds** *(Jan 2019-Mar 2020)*: Revived an inactive chapter; organised conferences, workshops, and meetups.

## Education & Executive Development

**Saïd Business School, University of Oxford** Oxford Emerging Leaders Programme (Blended) · Executive Education · Sep 2026-Present (in progress, first cohort)

13 weeks of live online learning followed by a three-day Oxford immersion. Developing systems thinking, stakeholder influence, strategic alignment, and change leadership through a playbook applied to a live organisational challenge.

**International University of Greece - Serres Campus**
Undergraduate studies in Informatics Engineering, 2007-2012 (degree not completed). Continued into full-time freelance work during the Greek economic crisis.

## Credentials

**AI Leader: Generative AI & Agentic AI for Leaders & Founders** · Udemy, Mar 2026
**Team Topologies Distilled** · Team Topologies Academy, Oct 2023
**Mental Health First Aid Champion** · MHFA England & UK Health Security Agency, 2022-2023
**Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I)** · Scrum.org, Aug 2021
**Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I)** · Scrum.org, Jun 2019

*Full credentials list available on the Credentials page.*